

The underlying intellectual principles came from you, but the formal scoring rubric was synthesized by me from our Ghost Story Lens conversations and documents.

You did ****not**** provide a single finished document saying, for example:

> Postmortem Identity = 20%
> Manifestation = 15%
> Causal Agency = 15%

Those eight categories, their numerical weights, the 1–10 score bands, and the labels such as ****Spectral-Adjacent Narrative**** and ****Paradigmatic Ghost Story**** were my operationalization of the project we had developed together.

What came directly from you

Across the project, you established the main scholarly commitments and repeatedly made or approved boundary decisions:

- * the historical frame of British ghost fiction from ****1764 to 1913****;
- * the need to distinguish ghost stories from broader Gothic and supernatural fiction;
- * the exclusion of works centered primarily on ****vampires, demons, doubles, fairies, and werewolves****;
- * the inclusion or retention of difficult cases involving ambiguous apparitions, supernatural hoaxes, uncertain manifestations, and rationalized hauntings;
- * the principle that merely containing the word **ghost**, **specter**, or **apparition** does not make a work a ghost story;
- * the importance of whether spectrality is central to plot, causation, evidence, perception, and interpretation;
- * the ghost–mediator–seer structure;
- * the claim that ghostly agency may be distributed through objects, architecture, atmosphere, documents, economic instruments, and technologies;
- * the preference for a ****spectrum****, rather than a rigid yes-or-no classifier;
- * the requirement that unusual texts should be able to expose and revise weaknesses in the criteria.

The Chapter 4 architecture records these principles explicitly. It states that generic identity emerges through relations among plot, causation, affect, evidence, material mediation, publication context, and reception, rather than through the presence of a supernatural term alone. It also records the inclusion of ambiguous apparitions and hoaxes and the exclusion of vampires, demons, doubles, fairies, and werewolves.

You also developed the dissertation's relational emphasis: spectral sources, ambient mediators, and attuned perceivers. The architecture defines a ghost story as a narrative in which relations among the dead, the living, and material or environmental mediators reorganize agency, perception, evidence, or causation.

What I created

I converted those premises into a reproducible analytical instrument.

The current PRD contains eight criteria:

Criterion	Weight
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Postmortem Identity	20%
Manifestation	15%
Causal Agency	15%
Narrative Centrality	15%
Structure of Return	10%
Ontological Status	10%
Mediation and Perception	10%
Generic Function	5%

I also created the present score bands:

- * **1.0–2.4:** Not a Ghost Story
- * **2.5–4.4:** Spectral-Adjacent Narrative
- * **4.5–6.4:** Borderline or Ambiguous Ghost Story
- * **6.5–8.4:** Strong Ghost Story
- * **8.5–10.0:** Paradigmatic Ghost Story

These appear in Appendix A of the PRD. Crucially, the PRD identifies them as **initial product requirements**, not immutable scholarly findings, and states that they must be validated through human annotation before being treated as stable criteria.

The PRD's revision history also accurately describes the concept as jointly developed by **Jong-Keyong (Jake) Kim / ChatGPT**. You supplied and approved the project's conceptual direction; I translated it into formal product and computational specifications.

How the proposed classifier currently works

The application is designed to make three separate judgments.

1. Entity ontology

It first asks what the apparent entity is:

- * human ghost or revenant;

- * ambiguous apparition;
- * demon or nonhuman spirit;
- * vampire;
- * double;
- * hallucination;
- * fraud;
- * technological trace;
- * metaphorical specter;
- * unexplained phenomenon.

This prevents the word **specter** or **spirit** from automatically generating a ghost-story classification.

2. Ghost-story fit

It then evaluates how closely the narrative corresponds to the eight-dimensional rubric.

A human ghost that appears once but has no effect on the plot might receive strong ***Postmortem Identity*** but weak ***Narrative Centrality*** and ***Causal Agency***.

A rationalized haunting may score highly for ***Manifestation***, ***Narrative Centrality***, and ***Structure of Return***, but lower for ***Ontological Status***.

A demon-centered story may contain extensive supernatural manifestations but score poorly for ***Postmortem Identity***.

3. Analytical confidence

Confidence is calculated separately from genre fit.

A text can therefore receive:

- > ***Ghost-Story Fit: 4.0/10***
- > ***Spectral-Adjacent Narrative***
- > ***Confidence: High***

That would mean the system is highly confident that the story does not closely correspond to the current ghost-story rubric.

Conversely:

- > ***Ghost-Story Fit: 6.0/10***
- > ***Borderline or Ambiguous Ghost Story***
- > ***Confidence: Low-Medium***

That would indicate substantial but conflicting textual evidence.

The most precise account of authorship

So the criteria were developed in three layers:

1. **Your dissertation supplied the theoretical and literary premises.**
2. **Our project conversations supplied inclusion decisions, exclusions, edge cases, and revisions.**
3. **I converted those materials into the formal eight-criterion rubric, weights, thresholds, and software logic.**

Therefore, it would be inaccurate to say either:

> "Jake gave ChatGPT a complete rubric."

or:

> "ChatGPT independently invented the criteria."

The accurate formulation is:

> **The rubric is an AI-assisted operationalization of Jong-Keyong Kim's dissertation framework, corpus decisions, and iterative genre adjudications.**

One important qualification remains: although you approved the overall blueprint and asked me to convert it into the PRD, **you have not yet separately validated or frozen the eight criteria, their definitions, their weights, or the score thresholds as the official British Ghost Story Criteria v1.0**. The PRD itself correctly treats them as provisional and human-reviewable rather than as established findings.